

The Dhāraṇī for Forceful Speech

Toh 790 · Derge Kangyur

ཚག་བཅན་པའ་གི་བྱུང་སྟེ།

The text known in English as The Dhāraṇī for Forceful Speech is a short invocation found in the Kangyur, where it is catalogued as Toh 790. The Tibetan title line closes with the words "the dhāraṇī of forceful speech is complete," and a Sanskrit title is not clearly attested in the source material, so it is best described simply by this Tibetan designation. It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of Buddhist literature, a genre of mnemonic or protective formulas whose recitation is said to bring about specific worldly or spiritual benefits. Here the stated benefit is that a person who enters an assembly will speak with authority and persuasive force. The text opens with homage to the Three Jewels, followed by the mantra itself, which begins with the syllables "oṃ alekāli alekāli mucite."

If one goes into an assembly, one's speech becomes forceful and commanding.

Here ends the dhāraṇī for forceful speech.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Tadyathā: Oṃ alekāli alekāli mucite

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens with the closing line of the benefit statement of the preceding dhāraṇī. The first word is most likely the remnant of an earlier clause, so the opening line is rendered as a self-contained statement of the dhāraṇī's benefit. The Tibetan "tshig btsan pa" literally means "strong, forceful words," and I have rendered it as forceful and commanding speech. The title formula marks the end of that dhāraṇī, and the following text begins a new one with the usual homage to the Three Jewels. The mantra syllables are given in standard transliteration of the Tibetan transcription of Sanskrit. "Alekāli" and "mucite" are transcribed as they appear, and the mantra is left untranslated, as is customary. The passage breaks off mid-mantra, so the text of that dhāraṇī continues beyond this excerpt.

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.